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Service Details

Apply for a New Driving Licence or a New Category Based on Exchanging

Licences

Exchange a Driving Licence issued outside the UAE and get a new one in Dubai, according to the list of countries eligible for exchange, or add a new category to Driving Licences issued in Dubai based on exchanging licences from authorised countries (list in Important to Know section).

Start Now
(https://dls.rta.ae/dls-login?journeyCode=EXCHANGE_LICENSE&lang=en)

Select the country that issued your Driving Licence

Other Countries

Output

UAE Driving Licence valid for 1 year if you're younger than 21, and for 2 years if you're 21 or older, or a new Driving Licence with the added category keeping the remaining validity period of your previous licence

Ways to Apply

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Steps

1. Go to Apply for a New Driving Licence or a New Category Based on Exchanging Licences .
2. Enter your Emirates ID, Passport, or UAE Pass details.
3. Enter the OTP sent to your registered mobile number.
4. If you have a People of Determination card (Sanad) issued by the Community Development Authority, you're automatically referred to the Dubai Health Authority to obtain the medical report related to the requested vehicle category. However, if you're a POD and have a card issued by the Ministry of Community Empowerment, you must submit a report on your medical condition with the required documents. The request is reviewed by the relevant team within 3 working days. You're then referred to the Dubai Health Authority to obtain the medical report related to the requested vehicle category.
5. Enter your personal information.
6. Upload the documents.
7. Submit the application and receive a reference number.
8. Enter the details of the existing Driving Licence.
9. Upload a copy of your Driving Licence and its legalised translation, if any.
10. Submit the application and receive the new reference number.
11. Take an eye test at one of the accredited Eye Test Centres.
12. Surrender your original Driving Licence at the Customer Happiness Centre, if required.
13. Receive an SMS on your registered phone number to pay the licence fees through RTA website:

Log in to your account on the website.

Click Licensing Services , then Driving Licence .

Click Pay Now and select a delivery method to receive the licence.

Click Next and pay the fees after reviewing them.

14. Receive the licence as a Digital Driving Licence. You can receive a physical copy through:

Self Service Machines (https://www.rta.ae/eservices/rtagisfindus/?lang=en&id=1&layerName=Smart%20Kiosk%20Machines)

Delivery service, with the fees as follows:

Standard delivery: AED 20

Same day delivery: AED 35

Delivery within 2 hours: AED 50

International delivery: AED 50.

15. Receive the licence through the RTA Dubai App

(https://www.rta.ae/wps/portal/rta/ae/home/smart-apps/app-details/rta-dubai/rta+dubai?lang=en) (My Docs), and add it to your Apple or Samsung Wallet. if RTA

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(https://www.digitaldubai.ae/)

(/wps/portal/rta/ae/home)

Important to Know

You Should Know

1. The Driving Licence to be exchanged must be valid.
2. In addition to the accredited Eye Test Centres, the eye test is also available in all Customer Happiness Centres and Driving Institutes.
3. Eye test fee varies between AED 140 and AED 180, according to the test centre.
4. In case the Driving Licence to be exchanged doesn't include security signs, you must provide a certificate verifying the validity of the data from the consulate or embassy of the country which issued the licence.
5. You can't replace your Driving Licence if it's issued by the countries listed below:

Guam island

Jersey island

Liechtenstein

Monaco

North Mariana

Puerto Rico

Andorra.

6. To add a new category based on exchanging licences:

You must be present in person when applying at Customer Happiness or Inspection Centres.

If your residence visa is issued from another emirate, you must present a proof of residence, study, or investment in Dubai.

7. To exchange a Driving Licence:

If you're a diplomat, apply through one of the Customer Happiness Centres in order to fulfil the requirements of your relevant exceptions.

If you're a diplomat, make sure the letter from the Ministry of Foreign Affairs is valid for at least 6 months from the date you submit the application.

If you submit a licence from one of the 20 exception countries listed below after opening a training file in Dubai because you hold a previous Driving Licence issued in an unauthorised country, you must present a Clearance Certificate and a certificate from the consulate or embassy attesting to the validity of the licence data in order to apply for a Driving Licence based on exchange.

List of the 20 countries eligible for exchange:

Licence Origin	Nationality	Licence Requires	The Foreign Licence	Replaceable
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0022480da975&lang=en)	Romania	All countries	No	No	All categories
(http://www.digitaldubai.ae/)	Germany	All countries	No	No	(/wps/portal/rta/ae/home) All categories
Italy	All countries	No	No	All categories	
Switzerland	All countries	No	No	All categories	
Poland	All countries	No	No	All categories	
Finland	All countries	No	No	All categories	
Spain	All countries	No	No	All categories	
Netherlands	All countries	No	No	All categories	
Sweden	All countries	No	No	All categories	
Belgium	All countries	No	No	All categories	
Turkey	All countries	Yes/embassy or consulate	No	All categories	
Denmark	All countries	No	No	All categories	
Austria	All countries	No	No	All categories	
France	All countries	No	No	All categories	
Britain	All countries	No	No	All categories	
Norway	All countries	No	No	All categories	
(http://www.digitaldubai.ae/home)	United States of America	All countries	No	Driver and Car Owner	(/wps/portal/rta/ae/home/about-services) Locations (/wps/portal/rta/ae/home/about-rta/contactus#findus)

0022480da975&lang=en)	Japan	All countries	Yes/legalised	No	All categories
(http://www.digitaldubai.ae/)	Hong Kong	All countries	Yes/legalised	No	(/wps/portal/rta/ae/home) All categories
	South Africa	All countries	No	No	All categories

If you're a GCC national, your GCC Driving Licence must be valid to replace it, and you must surrender it.

If you hold a GCC passport and a Driving Licence from the same country or from one of the exception countries, you can exchange it in Dubai regardless of your Emirates ID place of issuance.

The Driving Licence issued in the Republic of Turkey requires a Driving Licence Data Certificate from the consulate or embassy, certified by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, in accordance with the approved form.

You Should Do

1. Check if your country is on the list of countries eligible for exchange:

Licence Origin

Eligible Categories

Service Requirements

Fees

Payment Methods

Terms and Conditions

FAQs

Updated on: 05-March-2026

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RTA

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Related Services

حكومة دبي
GOVERNMENT OF DUBAI



Apply for or Manage a Driving Licence

View details (/wps/portal/rta/ae/home/rta-services/service-details?serviceId=616)

(/wps/portal/rta/ae/home)

Apply for Transferring Driving Prof Dubai

View details (/wps/portal/rta/ae/home/services/service-details?serviceId=135)

View all services

(/wps/portal/rta/ae/home/rta-services)

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(/wps/portal/rta/ae/home)

Driver and Car Owner (/wps/portal/rta/ae/drive-and-carowner)

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**Email us**

Send your questions or ideas by email.

(mailto:ask@rta.ae;)

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